

João Pedro Pamplona

Game Designer & Programmer · Unity Game Developer · C#

pamplona1999@gmail.com · (+351) 917 062 684 · Parede, Lisbon, Portugal · beastiebaiter.github.io/MyPortfolio/index.html · linkedin.com/in/jo%C3%A3o-pedro-pamplona-4a025a253

I'm a multi-discipline Game Designer and Developer with 6+ years of experience owning projects from concept to release, designing systems, implementing them in Unity with C#, and shipping across PC, mobile, and web. Co-founder of Barking Beagle Studios. Comfortable across the full stack: quest and combat design, Gameplay, UI and Physics programming. Hold a MSc in Computer Science Engineering with an expertise in Videogames from IST.

EXPERIENCE

Game Designer & Programmer · Barking Beagle Studios Jul 2023 - Present

Full-time · Lisbon, Portugal

- Owned the complete development cycle across multiple shipped titles: design, programming, UI, playtesting, and release
- Led the design of Quest Systems and Quest, Combat Mechanics & Systems, and Gameplay Loops across multiple shipped titles, owning each from concept through implementation right in engine (Unity)
- Authored detailed Game Design Documents covering quest, combat, and gameplay systems
- Built a third-person character controller, physics interactions, dynamic camera, and enemy AI from scratch
- Developed the PlayerBorders runtime component and a serialised Dictionary Editor tool custom systems that improved team workflow
- Full ownership of UI systems using Unity UGUI with DOTween animations
- Performance optimisation across PC and Web builds;
- Managed Git build pipelines and GitHub Flow
- Led playtest sessions and iterated on game feel, difficulty curves, and balance
- White-boxed level layouts and designed spatial progression and encounter placement
- Implemented designs directly in Unity (C#): prototyped gameplay, scripted interactions, and iterated on feel through playtesting

Games: P.I.G.E.O.N. (NTF 25 1st Place) · Buried Within Clay (In-development, selected for Codfish × Dear Villagers Game Clinic) · Foam Sweet Foam · Tavern Keeper (Select by APVP for Game Mentorship with Jason Della Rocca) · The Wizards Apprentice

Project Lead: Designer, Programmer & Producer · GameDev Técnico × LPCC - HPV: Combate Viral Jun 2023 - Oct 2024

Part-time · Lisbon, Portugal

- Led the Combat and Gameplay Design of the Card battler Combat System and educational gameplay loop for a teenage audience
- Balanced educational requirements from the LPCC partner stakeholders, against an engaging player experience
- Authored the GDD and design documentation for all game systems
- Led a team of 5 across design, programming, and art as Project Lead, from concept to release on 3 platforms
- Presented design decisions and project progress to LPCC partner stakeholder
- Sole owner of all UI systems (UGUI + DOTween); implemented card-battle logic, state management, and gameplay flow
- Managed production, milestones, and stakeholder communication with LPCC

Platforms: PC · Android (Play Store) · Web

Executive Producer & Game Developer · GameDev Técnico Jan 2022 - Jul 2025

Part-time · Volunteer · Lisbon, Portugal

- Led, Mentored, designed, developed, and shipped 20+ games across game jams, partnered, and internal projects
- Participated in 12 game jams, building rapid-prototyping and delivery skills across diverse genres
- Led production and planning of 3 internal game jams for a community of ~100 members as Executive Producer

Co-Organizer · Azul Game Jam Dec 2025 - Present

Part-time · Lisbon, Portugal

- Co-organised a 48-hour on-site game development marathon in Lisbon for nearly 40 participants
- Shared responsibility across production, planning, partner relations, and logistics

ACCOLADES & RECOGNITION

- P.I.G.E.O.N. - 1st place, NTF 25 Games Category (FNAC Novos Talentos Festival)
- Buried Within Clay - selected for the Codfish × Dear Villagers Game Clinic: Pitch Your Game to a Real Publisher
- Co-organiser of Azul Game Jam (Lisbon, ~40 participants, 2025-present)
- Tavern Keeper - select by APVP for Game Mentorship with Jason Della Rocca

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science Engineering - Expertise in Video Games · Instituto Superior Técnico · Universidade de Lisboa Sep 2023 - Oct 2025

- Thesis: Digital Biomarker-based Games for Children - with Prof. Rui Prada, INESC-ID
- Game Design (18/20) · Game Development Methodology (17/20)

BSc Computer Science Engineering · NOVA School of Science and Technology · FCT NOVA Sep 2019 - Jun 2023

SKILLS

Game Design: Quest Design · Combat & Enemy Design · RPG Systems · Gameplay Design · Narrative Design · Level Design (White-boxing) · Prototyping & Playtesting · Design Documentation (GDD)

Programming: Unity - 6 yrs (C#, 2D, 3D, UGUI, Shaders, Gameplay) · Unreal Engine 5 - 1 yr · Godot - 1 yr

Engineering: Design Patterns / OOP · Performance Profiling · Custom Editor Tooling · DOTween · Visual Scripting · Git · GitHub · GitHub Flow · Build Pipeline Management

Scripting & Tools: Unity (C#) · Visual Scripting · Obsidian · YouTrack · Notion · ClickUp · Jira · Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Slides) · Microsoft Office · Figma · Draw.io · Miro

Methodologies: Agile / Scrum · Milestone Planning · Sprint Management · Risk Assessment · Stakeholder Communication

Soft Skills: Meticulous attention to detail · Proactivity · Discretion · Clear communication · Multi-stakeholder management · Team Leadership · Cross-discipline Collaboration · Adaptability · Decision-making under constraints

TTRPG & DESIGN PROJECTS

Game Master & Homebrew Designer · Dungeons & Dragons 5e 2022 - Present

- 3+ years designing and running campaigns: original quests, branching narrative, NPC motivations, encounter design, and custom magic items and rules
- Campaign management in Notion and Obsidian: quest-state tracking, faction relationships, and lore documentation
- Homebrew compendium of original magic items, custom mechanics, and rule modifications

Solo Designer - Divinity: Original Sin TTRPG Conversion · Personal Project 2023 - 2024

- Fan-made conversion translating Divinity Original Sin's combat systems, AP economy, elemental interactions, into tabletop rules

github.com/BeastieBaiter/Divinity-TTRPG

Solo Designer - Fado TTRPG · Personal Project 2024 - Present

- Original TTRPG: a deck-builder/skill-tree hybrid system designed to empower player roleplay and agency

drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ap4YUnDv_YoPivVhGlzvBAI56mHUrUeM

LANGUAGES

Portuguese - Native

English - Full professional proficiency (C1)